

Study 1 Questionnaire: South Korea

English Translation

Survey flow

1. Consent block.
2. Attention-check block. If “I have a question” is not selected in Q2, end the survey.
3. Demographics (part1), party identification (Part 2), and social-distance/affective-polarization questions (Part 3).
4. Randomize the order of the `Political_facts` and `Non-political_facts` blocks.
5. Randomize the order of the `Conspiracy theories_R` and `Conspiracy theories_L` blocks.
6. Background and attitude questions (Part8), followed by the debriefing block.

Block: consent

Q1 This survey asks for your opinions on recent political issues and will take approximately 10 minutes to complete. The findings will be reported in academic journals and presented at seminars and conferences. No information that could identify individual respondents will be made public. All data will be stored securely in digital form on a password-protected computer. After the study is completed, de-identified data will be added to a publicly accessible database, where researchers may use them indefinitely.

Participation is voluntary, and you may withdraw at any time. Please note that compensation may not be provided if you do not follow the instructions. This study has been approved by the Institutional Ethics Board of the Faculty of Law at Keio University.

For questions or assistance, please contact Yuko Kasuya at ykasuya@keio.jp.

If you wish to participate, please select “Agree to participate in the survey” below.

- Agree to participate in the survey (1)
- Do not agree to participate in the survey (3)

Block: part0

Q2 Careful responses to the survey questions are very important for this study. To confirm that you are reading the questions carefully, please select “I have a question” from the options below. Thank you for your cooperation.

- I understand the above (1)
- I do not understand the above (2)
- I have a question (3)

Block: part1

Q3 What is your gender?

- Male (1)
- Female (2)
- Other (3)
- Prefer not to answer (4)

Q4 What is your age? (Please answer using your age at your last birthday.)

- Under 18 (8)
- 18–29 (2)
- 30–39 (3)
- 40–49 (4)
- 50–59 (5)
- 60–69 (6)
- 70 or older (7)

Q6 In which region do you currently live?

- Seoul (1)
- Busan (2)
- Daegu (3)
- Incheon (4)
- Gwangju (5)
- Daejeon (6)
- Ulsan (7)
- Sejong (8)
- Gyeonggi-do (9)
- Gangwon-do (10)
- Chungcheongbuk-do (11)
- Chungcheongnam-do (12)
- Jeollabuk-do (13)
- Jeollanam-do (14)
- Gyeongsangbuk-do (15)
- Gyeongsangnam-do (16)
- Jeju-do (17)

Block: Part 2

Q9 Do you usually consider yourself close to any particular political party?

- No (1)
- Yes (2)

Display logic

If Q9 = No

Q10 Do you feel at least a little closer to one political party than to the others?

- No (1)
- Yes (2)

Display logic

If Q9 = Yes

Or Q10 = Yes

Q11 Which political party do you feel closest to?

- People Power Party (1)
- Democratic Party of Korea (2)
- Reform Party (4)
- Other (5) _____

Display logic

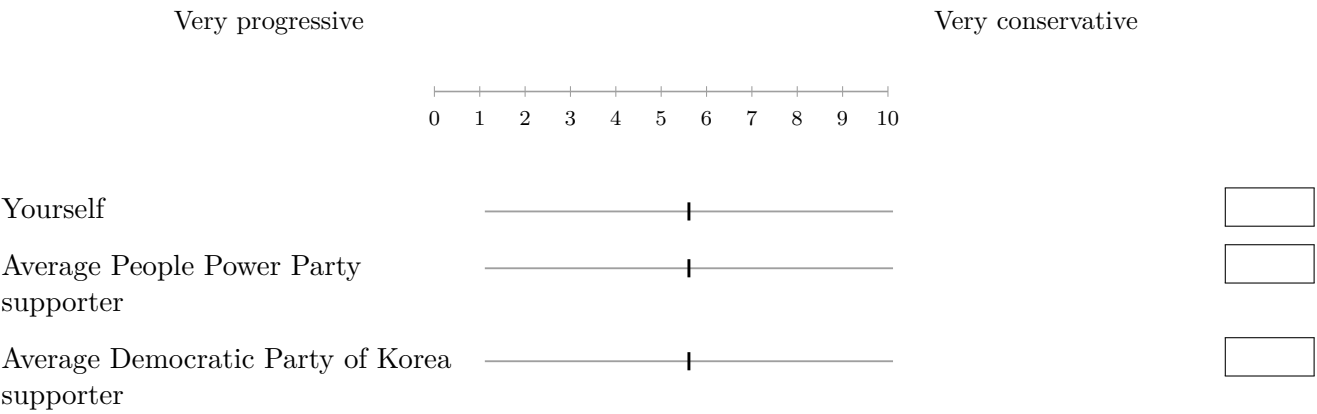
If Q9 = Yes

Or Q10 = Yes

Q12 Do you feel very close to this party, somewhat close, or not very close?

- Very close (1)
- Somewhat close (2)
- Not very close (3)

Q14 In politics, people often talk about progressives and conservatives. On a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 means “extremely progressive” and 10 means “extremely conservative,” where would you place yourself, the average People Power Party supporter, and the average Democratic Party of Korea supporter?



Block: Part 3

Q17 Is there any political party you would never vote for in an election, regardless of who the candidate is?

- Yes (1)
- No (2)

Display logic

If Q17 = Yes

Q18 If there are any parties listed above that you would never vote for, please select all that apply.

- ☐ People Power Party (1)
- ☐ Democratic Party of Korea (2)
- ☐ Reform Party (4)
- ☐ Other (5) _____

Q19 How would you feel about having each of the following relationships with a supporter of the People Power Party?

	Dislike very much (1)	Dislike somewhat (2)	Like somewhat (3)	Like very much (4)
Having a supporter as a colleague at my workplace (1)	○	○	○	○
Having a supporter as a close friend (2)	○	○	○	○
Having a supporter as my spouse or my child's spouse (3)	○	○	○	○

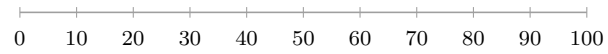
Q20 How would you feel about having each of the following relationships with a supporter of the Democratic Party of Korea?

	Dislike very much (1)	Dislike somewhat (2)	Like somewhat (3)	Like very much (4)
Having a supporter as a colleague at my workplace (1)	○	○	○	○
Having a supporter as a close friend (2)	○	○	○	○
Having a supporter as my spouse or my child's spouse (3)	○	○	○	○

Q21 On a scale from 0 to 100, where 0 means very cold or unfavorable feelings and 100 means very warm or favorable feelings, how warmly do you feel toward supporters of each political party?

Cold/Unfavorable feelings

Warm/Favorable feelings



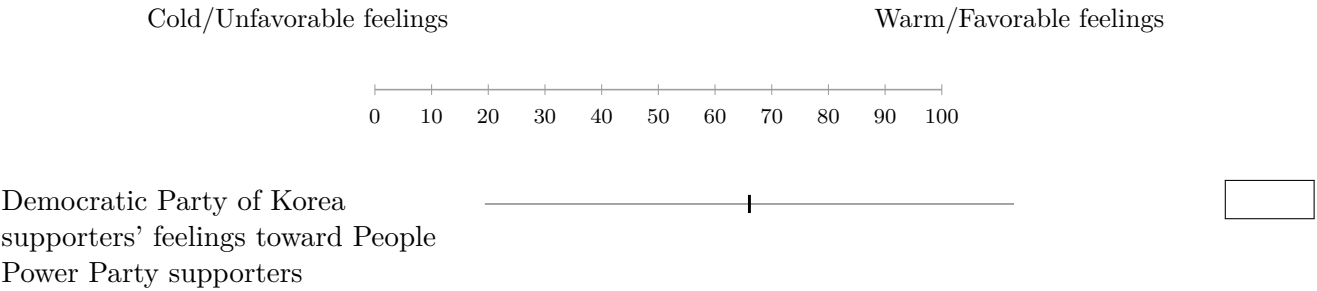
People Power Party supporters



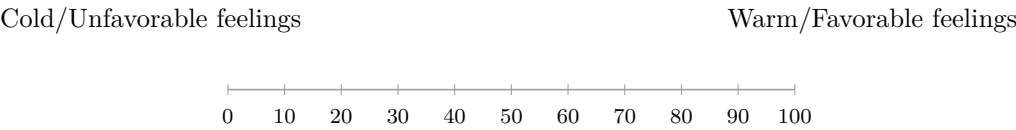
Democratic Party of Korea
supporters



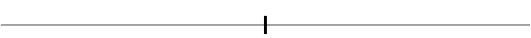
Q22 On a scale from 0 to 100, where 0 means very cold or unfavorable feelings and 100 means very warm or favorable feelings, how warmly do you think supporters of the Democratic Party of Korea feel toward supporters of the People Power Party? This question asks about your perception of Democratic Party of Korea supporters' feelings toward People Power Party supporters, not about your own feelings.



Q23 On a scale from 0 to 100, where 0 means very cold or unfavorable feelings and 100 means very warm or favorable feelings, how warmly do you think supporters of the People Power Party feel toward supporters of the Democratic Party of Korea? This question asks about your perception of People Power Party supporters' feelings toward Democratic Party of Korea supporters, not about your own feelings.



People Power Party supporters’
feelings toward Democratic Party of
Korea supporters



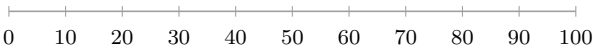
Q90 In the following questions, you will be asked to judge whether each of 12 statements is true or false and to estimate how accurately you think other people would judge each statement. Please do not look up the answers online. The purpose of this survey is to understand your intuitive judgment.

Block: Political_facts

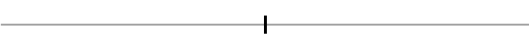
Q45 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “The term of office for members of the National Assembly is two years.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

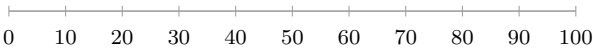
Q46 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



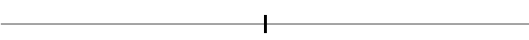
Confidence that your answer is correct



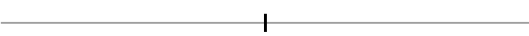
Q47 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



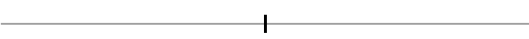
People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



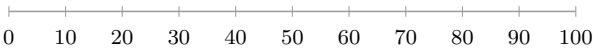
Nonpartisans



Q48 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “To amend the Constitution, more than half of the votes in a national referendum must be in favor.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

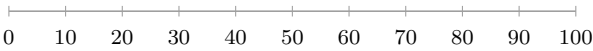
Q49 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



Confidence that your answer is correct



Q50 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



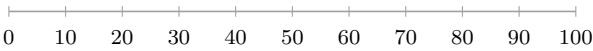
Nonpartisans



Q51 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “South Korea’s nominal GDP growth rate in the previous year was below 5%.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

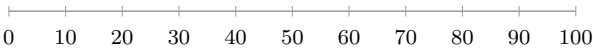
Q52 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



Confidence that your answer is correct



Q53 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



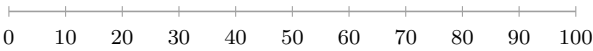
Nonpartisans



Q54 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “In South Korea, there are 40 people aged 65 or older for every 100 working-age people (ages 15–64).”

- True (1)
- False (2)

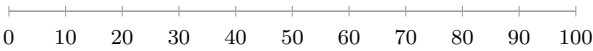
Q55 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



Confidence that your answer is correct



Q56 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



Nonpartisans

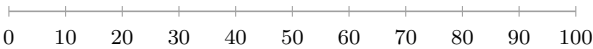


Block: Non-political_facts

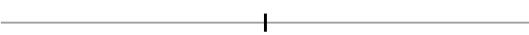
Q60 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “New Zealand is a country located in the Middle East.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

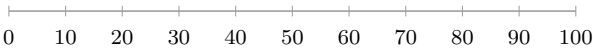
Q61 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



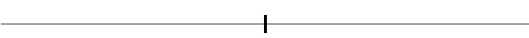
Confidence that your answer is correct



Q62 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



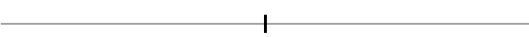
People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



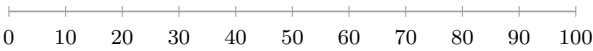
Nonpartisans



Q66 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “The iPhone was invented before 2000.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

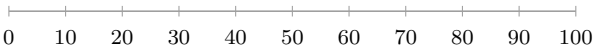
Q67 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



Confidence that your answer is correct



Q68 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



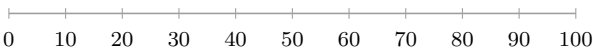
Nonpartisans



Q69 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “Under the law, a person must be at least 19 years old to drink alcohol.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

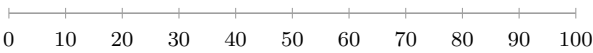
Q70 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



Confidence that your answer is correct



Q71 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



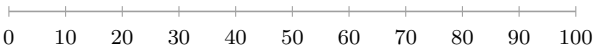
Nonpartisans



Q72 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “The highest mountain in South Korea is Hallasan.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

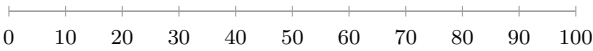
Q73 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



Confidence that your answer is correct



Q74 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



Nonpartisans

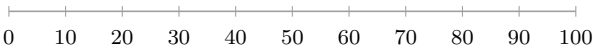


Block: Conspiracy theories_R

Q75 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “There was widespread election fraud in the 2020 and 2024 National Assembly elections.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

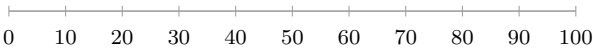
Q76 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



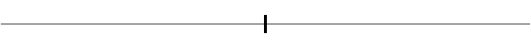
Confidence that your answer is correct



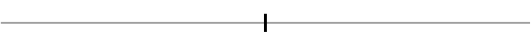
Q77 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



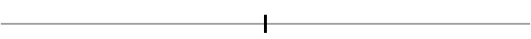
People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



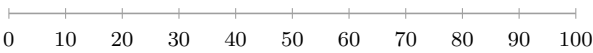
Nonpartisans



Q81 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “China is systematically infiltrating major institutions in South Korea to weaken the country’s democracy and sovereignty.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

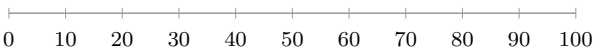
Q82 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



Confidence that your answer is correct



Q83 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



Nonpartisans

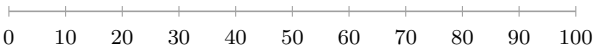


Block: Conspiracy theories_L

Q91 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “The Supreme Court colluded with Yoon Suk-yeol and decided to disqualify Lee Jae-myung from the presidential election.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

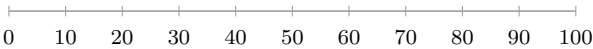
Q92 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



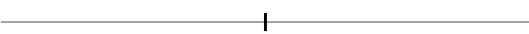
Confidence that your answer is correct



Q93 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



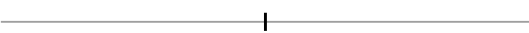
People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



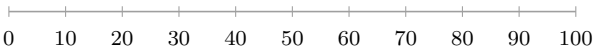
Nonpartisans



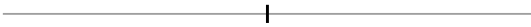
Q94 Please judge whether the following statement is true or false: “The U.S. government controls major political decisions in South Korea, including crackdowns on opposition parties and policy decisions under conservative administrations.”

- True (1)
- False (2)

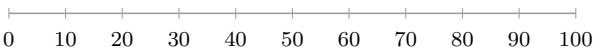
Q95 Please indicate how confident you are in your judgment on a scale from 0 to 100. Select 100 if you are completely certain that your judgment is correct and 0 if you have no confidence at all.



Confidence that your answer is correct



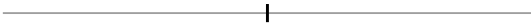
Q96 Next, please estimate the percentage of people in each group below who would correctly determine whether this statement is true or false. For example, if you think everyone in a group would answer correctly, enter 100% for that group.



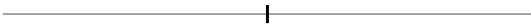
People Power Party supporters



Democratic Party of Korea supporters



Nonpartisans



Block: Part8

Q5 What is the highest level of education you have completed?

- Middle school graduate or lower (1)
- High school graduate (2)
- Graduate of a two-year college or four-year university (3)
- Master's degree or higher (4)

Q7 What is your household's total annual income? Please select the category closest to your household's pre-tax income.

- KRW 25,000,000 or less (1)
- KRW 25,000,001–35,000,000 (2)
- KRW 35,000,001–50,000,000 (3)
- KRW 50,000,001–60,000,000 (4)
- KRW 60,000,001–70,000,000 (5)
- KRW 70,000,001–80,000,000 (6)
- KRW 80,000,001 or more (7)

Q31 What is your religion?

- Buddhism (1)
- Christianity (e.g., Protestantism or Catholicism) (2)
- No religion (3)
- Other (4) _____

Q15 Please read the following statements and indicate how closely each statement matches your own perspective. Some statements may seem similar, but please answer each one as though it were new.

	Very different from my view (1)	Somewhat different from my view (2)	Somewhat similar to my view (3)	Very similar to my view (4)
I feel uncomfortable listening to someone whose political views differ from mine. (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐
I try to discuss opposing political views with other people. (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is pointless for people with different political views to argue with one another. (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐
People with different political views can still learn from one another. (4)	☐	☐	☐	☐
My political viewpoint is more valid than other viewpoints. (5)	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q16 Please indicate your position on each of the following statements using a scale from 0 to 6, where 0 means “do not agree at all” and 6 means “agree completely.”

	Do not agree at all (1)	Disagree (2)	Somewhat disagree (3)	Somewhat agree (4)	Agree (5)	Strongly agree (6)
Some groups are inherently inferior to other groups. (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is not a problem if some groups have more opportunities than other groups. (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
To get what your group wants, it is sometimes necessary to use violence against other groups. (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We should do everything we can to equalize conditions among the different groups in society. (4)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Making all groups equal does not necessarily have to be our highest priority. (5)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No group should monopolize power in society. (6)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Block: debunking

Q100 Thank you for participating.

The statements you judged as true or false above were based on representative conspiracy claims that are widely circulated in South Korean society. Based on existing research and the evidence available to date, most of the following claims are considered unlikely to be true:

- There was widespread election fraud in the 2020 and 2024 National Assembly elections.
- China is deliberately infiltrating national institutions in order to weaken the democracy and sovereignty of the Republic of Korea.
- The Supreme Court colluded with Yoon Suk-yeol and decided to disqualify Lee Jae-myung from the presidential election.
- The U.S. government controls major political decisions in South Korea and is involved in crackdowns on opposition parties and policy decisions under conservative administrations.

This survey is part of a study designed to understand how citizens perceive these claims and how confident they are in those perceptions. Thank you again for participating.